

WOLSELEY AVENUE, E6 — HMO SURVEY CRIB SHEET

Survey briefing, site capture sheet, homeowner discussion prompts, and first-stage HMO / licensing guide

Working address	Wolseley Avenue, E6, London (exact house number to be confirmed before or on arrival)
Working use of document	Pre-survey briefing for evening site visit
Proposed attendees	Zafer Khan, Mike, Zakir (attendance to be confirmed on the day)
Lead source	Relationship lead introduced via Zakir
Working project brief	Survey an existing house, understand the owner's objectives, assess whether an HMO route is realistic, capture measurements and photographs, and identify the correct next step.
Immediate outcome required	Leave the site with a disciplined understanding of the owner's objectives, the likely planning / licensing / building regulations path, the layout constraints, and the correct next paid stage.
Important unknowns	Exact house number; current lawful use; exact target occupancy; whether structural works or extension are actually intended; whether any previous drawings, applications or advice already exist.
Important caution	Do not promise planning approval, licence grant, structural feasibility, fire strategy sign-off, final occupancy numbers, or a final build price on site.

Regulatory note: This is a practical working survey sheet. It is not legal advice, a planning determination, a structural engineer's report, a fire risk assessment, or a licence decision.

PAGE 1 — ON-SITE SURVEY CAPTURE TABLE

Use: Complete this table first on site. It is intentionally spacious so there is room for corrections, extra notes, and measured height information.

Room / area	L (m)	W (m)	H (m)	Low headroom / <1.5m areas?	Current use	Possible HMO use?	Window / light / ventilation	Notes / defects / comments
Front external								
Hallway								
Reception 1 / bedroom?								
Reception 2 / bedroom?								
Kitchen								
Bathroom / shower room								
WC								
Landing / stairs								
Bedroom 1								
Bedroom 2								
Bedroom 3								
Bedroom 4								
Loft / attic								
Rear external /								

garden								
Boiler / services								
Meters / consumer unit								
Escape route								
Other								

Measurement note: For bedrooms, record the full room dimensions and separately note any areas below 1.5m ceiling height, chimney breasts, bulkheads, eaves, or en-suite areas that reduce usable sleeping space.

1. TONIGHT'S MISSION — WHAT A GOOD SURVEY LOOKS LIKE

Understand exactly what the homeowner is trying to achieve: HMO conversion, improved rental yield, reconfiguration, extension, or a phased upgrade.

Measure the property properly so room sizes, circulation, kitchen / bathroom capacity, escape route quality, and likely occupancy limits can be assessed afterwards.

Photograph all rooms, circulation spaces, bathrooms, kitchen, boiler / consumer unit, exterior front and rear, and any defect, structural clue, or layout constraint relevant to an HMO route.

Hold a confident but measured conversation with the homeowner: clear on the framework, clear on the unknowns, and careful not to over-promise.

Leave the site with the right next-step recommendation: measured survey review, feasibility note, layout testing, drawings, planning / licensing advice, or later quotation.

Best closing line: "Thank you — this gives a much clearer picture. The measurements, photos and compliance points will now be reviewed properly so the next step is based on evidence rather than guesswork."

2. CORE HMO POSITION — HOW TO SPEAK CREDIBLY AND SAFELY

A. What an HMO is

An HMO is typically a property occupied by 3 or more people forming 2 or more households who share facilities such as a kitchen or bathroom.

The planning side, the licensing side, and the building regulations side are separate and all may need attention on the same project.

The final layout must work not only on paper, but also in practical use: sleeping room sizes, kitchen standards, bathroom provision, fire precautions, means of escape, heating, ventilation, and property management all matter.

B. Safe statements that can be used on site

The right route depends on current use, intended occupancy, layout, and whether any structural or extension works are proposed.

A normal dwelling changing to an HMO in Newham usually raises a planning issue because of the borough's Article 4 controls.

Even if planning is achievable, the layout still has to satisfy HMO licensing and building regulations requirements.

If structural walls are moved, or if an extension is proposed, building regulations and likely engineer input become relevant.

The correct next step may be measured survey review and layout testing before any promise is made on occupancy or build cost.

C. Statements to avoid

"This will definitely get planning."

"That room is definitely legal as a bedroom."

"Six people will definitely fit here."

"No licence / building regs / fire upgrades will be needed."

"A final price can be given tonight."

3. LICENSING POSITION — CLEARER AND MORE COMPLETE

A. The three licensing routes to keep separate

Selective licence: in Newham, privately rented properties that are not mandatory or additional HMOs generally require a selective licence, subject to the borough scheme area and any exemption.

Additional HMO licence: applies where a property is occupied by 3–4 people forming 2 or more households and sharing facilities, or where the occupiers do not have exclusive occupation of the whole property.

Mandatory HMO licence: applies where an HMO is occupied by 5 or more people forming 2 or more households.

Important distinction: where the property falls into HMO licensing, the HMO licence route applies rather than the selective licence route.

B. Practical wording for the homeowner

There are different licence routes depending on how many people and households are involved.

If the property remains a normal private rental and is not an HMO, the selective licence route may still apply in Newham.

If the property becomes a 3–4 person shared house with 2 or more households, the additional HMO licence route is normally the relevant one.

If the property becomes a 5+ person shared house with 2 or more households, the mandatory HMO licence route is normally the relevant one.

Licensing is separate from planning. Having the right licence is not the same thing as having the right planning status.

C. Planning overlay to remember

Newham's Article 4 direction means that changing from a normal dwelling (C3) to a small HMO (C4) usually requires planning permission in this borough.

Larger / more intensive HMOs and any extension, external works, or structural alterations can increase planning complexity further.

The safe on-site position is that planning needs to be checked properly against the actual proposal, layout, occupancy level, and site context.

4. HOMEOWNER DISCUSSION SCRIPT — QUESTIONS TO ASK

A. Project aim and commercial objective

What is the main objective here — HMO conversion, better rental income, general refurbishment first, or something else?

How many occupants are being targeted eventually?

Are standard rooms envisaged only, or are en-suites being considered as well?

What tenant type is intended — professional sharers, students, supported housing, or another profile?

Is there a target budget already in mind, or is the aim to understand what is realistically required first?

B. Existing position

What is the property used as now — single household, rental, vacant, or partly occupied?

Has it ever been used as an HMO or had any HMO licence before?

Has any discussion already taken place with the council, a planner, an architect, a builder, or an engineer?

Are any previous drawings, applications, decisions, certificates, or refusal notices available?

Are there any known problems with neighbours, parking, refuse, damp, structure, or previous works?

C. Scope and works

Which walls are being considered for removal, movement, or alteration?

Is any extension, loft conversion, dormer, or outbuilding being considered, or is the proposal within the existing envelope only?

Does the kitchen remain in place, or is relocation / enlargement being considered?

How many bathrooms or shower rooms are being targeted?

Is the immediate requirement survey and advice only, or is measured drawing, planning support, and build pricing also expected later?

D. Timing and decisions

How quickly is the owner hoping to move?

Are there current tenants whose departure affects access or programme?

Who is the final decision-maker on fees, consultant appointment, and contractor appointment?

What matters most in choosing the team — price, speed, planning knowledge, or full end-to-end delivery?

Would a phased route be acceptable: feasibility first, then drawings / planning, then build budget or quote?

5. SURVEY METHOD — HOW TO DO THE VISIT PROPERLY

A. Minimum kit

Laser / handheld tape measure

Phone cameras fully charged

Notebook and pen

This room-by-room capture sheet

Torch if light is poor

Awareness of loft, cellar, stairs and trip hazards

B. Order of survey

Front external: frontage, entrance, bin space, side access, neighbouring context, parking clues.

Ground floor: hallway, reception rooms, stairs, kitchen, WC / bathroom, rear access, garden / extension potential.

Upper floors: each room, landings, bathroom positions, chimney breasts, window sizes, ceiling heights.

Service points: boiler, cylinder, gas meter, electric meter, consumer unit, extraction routes, drainage clues.

Condition and risk: damp, mould, cracking, sloping floors, poor ventilation, ad-hoc alterations, overloaded electrics.

C. What to measure

Overall internal room dimensions (length x width).

Height, especially where ceilings slope or are boxed in.

Door widths and positions.

Window sizes and positions.

Stair width and landing widths.

Kitchen size and appliance layout.

Bathroom / WC size and layout.

Rear garden or yard depth if extension is discussed.

Structural clues such as wall thickness, chimney breast widths, long spans, and direction of joists where visible.

6. HMO SPECIFICATION CHECKLIST — PRACTICAL BENCHMARKS

A. Sleeping-room thresholds

Below 4.64 m²: not suitable for sleeping accommodation.

4.64 m² to 6.50 m²: suitable only for one child under 10.

6.51 m² to 10.21 m²: suitable for one person aged 10 or over.

10.22 m² or more: suitable for two persons aged 10 or over.

Any floor area below 1.5m ceiling height does not count toward the sleeping-room area.

Rooms that only just scrape past minimum figures can still be weak rooms in practical or commercial terms.

B. Shared kitchen guide in Newham

Up to 3 sharers: about 5.5 m².

4–5 sharers: about 7.5 m².

6–7 sharers: about 9.5 m².

8–10 sharers: about 11.5 m².

Practical test as well as size: circulation, worktop length, storage, fridge / freezer capacity, sockets, extraction, and safe use all matter.

C. Shared kitchen facilities to look for

Adequate cooker provision for expected occupancy.

Sink / drainer with hot and cold water.

Sufficient fixed worktop length.

Food storage cupboards.

Adequate fridge / freezer provision.

Sufficient electrical sockets above work surfaces.

Washable floor finish and adequate ventilation.

Kitchen should not be in a hallway and should not be the only access route to a sleeping room.

D. Bathroom / WC guide in Newham

1–4 occupiers: at least one bath or shower with wash hand basin; WC may be in the same room.

5 occupiers: one bath / shower room plus a separate WC with wash hand basin is the practical benchmark.

6–10 occupiers: typically two bathrooms with wash hand basins and two WCs, with at least one WC in its own compartment with a wash hand basin.

Bathrooms and shower rooms need adequate heating and ventilation.

E. Fire / escape / safety points

At least one smoke alarm on every floor of rented property is expected as a baseline; interlinked smoke / heat alarms are expected in licensed property standards.

A kitchen heat detector is strongly advisable.

Check whether the escape route from upper floors to final exit can be kept protected and unobstructed.

Look carefully at doors opening onto the escape route, open-plan layouts, low headroom, steep stairs, cluttered circulation, and kitchen position.

F. Heating, ventilation and certificates to remember

Heating should be adequate for living rooms, bedrooms and bathrooms.

Bathrooms and shower rooms require adequate extraction and ventilation.

Gas appliances must be safe and annually checked by a Gas Safe engineer.

Electrical installations in rented property require periodic inspection and testing by a qualified person.

EPC requirements still sit alongside the HMO discussion.

7. PHOTO CHECKLIST — DO NOT LEAVE WITHOUT THESE

Front elevation and front door

Street context, parking and bin position

Rear elevation and garden / yard

Every bedroom from doorway and opposite corner

Every bathroom / WC

Kitchen from multiple corners

Hallway, stairs and landings

Boiler, cylinder, meters and consumer unit

Any crack, damp patch, mould, ceiling stain, improvised repair, chimney breast, beam, or altered wall

Any area relevant to an extension or external works

Existing alarm / detector positions where visible

8. IMMEDIATE POST-VISIT DEBRIEF — QUESTIONS TO ANSWER BEFORE ANY ADVICE OR QUOTE

Is the owner's objective now fully understood, or are there still major ambiguities?

What is the most realistic occupancy range the existing property could support before any extension or major works?

What are the likely gating items: planning application, licence route, measured drawings, structural engineer, fire strategy, building regulations, party wall issues, extension design, or utilities upgrade?

What is the correct next paid step: measured survey review only, feasibility / layout options, planning advice, planning package, build budget, or later quotation?

Is this worth progressing, progressing with caveats, or declining because the owner's expectations are unrealistic?

Recommended internal output after the visit

One concise survey summary

One annotated room schedule

One organised photo set

One compliance / risk list

One recommended next step with fee basis if appropriate

APPENDIX — QUICK REFERENCE

HMO threshold in simple terms: 3+ people, 2+ households, shared facilities.

Newham additional HMO licence: 3–4 people, 2+ households.

Newham mandatory HMO licence: 5+ people, 2+ households.

Selective licence: generally applies to privately rented property in Newham that is not an additional or mandatory HMO, subject to scheme area and exemptions.

Bedroom thresholds: 6.51 m² one adult; 10.22 m² two adults; 4.64 m² one child under 10; below 4.64 m² not for sleeping.

Do not count floor area below 1.5m ceiling height toward sleeping-room size.

Shared kitchen guide in Newham: 5.5 m² (up to 3); 7.5 m² (4–5); 9.5 m² (6–7); 11.5 m² (8–10).

Planning, licensing and building regulations remain separate workstreams.